

RESOLUTION NO. _____

ENTITLED: “A RESOLUTION AUTHORIZING THE SUBMISSION OF AN AMERICORPS SENIORS FOSTER GRANDPARENT PROGRAM APPLICATION TO AMERICORPS ON BEHALF OF THE GOVERNING BODY OF THE CITY OF CHEYENNE FOR A THREE-YEAR CONTINUATION OF FUNDING FOR THE YOUTH ALTERNATIVES FOSTER GRANDPARENT PROGRAM AND RELATED SUPPORT ITEMS.”

WHEREAS, the Governing Body of the City of Cheyenne (“City”) requests assistance in funding the AmeriCorps Seniors Foster Grandparent Program mentoring and enrichment program and related necessary support items (the “Project”);

WHEREAS, the City recognizes the need for this Project;

WHEREAS, the City desires to participate in the AmeriCorps Seniors Foster Grandparent Program grant program;

WHEREAS, the AmeriCorps Seniors Foster Grandparent Program has certain criteria that must be met as established by AmeriCorps, and to the best of the City’s knowledge, the proposed application satisfies those criteria;

WHEREAS, grant funding for this Project will be considered by AmeriCorps after submission on April 3, 2026;

WHEREAS, the total estimated annual programming budget is Three Hundred Twenty-six thousand Sixty-Eight (\$326,068.00), and the City requests a grant in this amount; and

WHEREAS, the City is not required to provide a matching contribution for this grant.

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED BY THE GOVERNING BODY OF THE CITY OF CHEYENNE, WYOMING, that the City supports the submission of a continuation application for the AmeriCorps Seniors Foster Grandparent Program grant to fund the Project;

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the Mayor of the City of Cheyenne is authorized to sign and submit an application for an AmeriCorps Seniors Foster Grandparent Program grant in the amount of Three Hundred Twenty-Six Thousand Sixty-Eight Dollars (\$326,068.00) per year, for a total amount of Nine Hundred Seventy-Eight Thousand Two Hundred Four Dollars (\$978,204.00), to be submitted to AmeriCorps Seniors for renewal for three (3) years beginning July 1, 2026, through June 30, 2029, for assistance in funding the Project; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the Mayor of the City of Cheyenne is hereby designated as the authorized representative of the City to act on behalf of the Governing Body on all matters relating to this grant application, and, in the event grant funds are awarded, the Mayor is authorized to execute the grant agreement and any associated documents.

PRESENTED, READ AND ADOPTED THIS _____ DAY OF _____, 2026.

Patrick Collins, Mayor

(SEAL)

ATTEST:

Kylie Soden, City Clerk

26/29 Renewal Grant

The City of Cheyenne Office of Youth Alternatives proposes to have 30-55 AmeriCorps Senior volunteers who will serve through tutoring and mentoring student interaction, promoting social/emotional development in Laramie, Platte, and Goshen counties. AmeriCorps Seniors volunteers will serve 36 Volunteer Service Years (VSY) each year. The primary focus area of this project is Education for school readiness and K-12 success. AmeriCorps Seniors volunteers will be responsible for approximately 540 students receiving services from Foster Grandparent volunteers. The AmeriCorps investment of \$326,068.00 will be supplemented by an anticipated \$51,272.00.00 in resources.

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Wyoming, located in the mountain region of the Western United States, is the 10th largest state by area, totaling 97,814 square miles. It is also the least populous at six people per square mile and is the second most populated state with a total population of 587,618. Of the total population, 111,865 are 65 and over a 12.1 % increase, with an additional 22% under 18. Six percent of children in Wyoming live in poverty. The median age for the state is 38.8, one of the countries' fastest growing. According to the Wyoming Department of Health, by 2030, over one-fifth of the state's population is expected to be over age 65.

Given that Wyoming is considered a rural state, characterized mainly by the mountain ranges and rangelands of the Rocky Mountains, obtaining necessary services such as healthcare becomes difficult for many of the state's residents. Wyoming Medicaid's long-term care costs are projected to increase to \$184 million by 2030, according to the Wyoming Department of Health's Annual Report. However, this may change due to enrollment in Wyoming Medicaid declining 14.1% from 2024. Unemployment, poverty, and median income rates also fell, according to the Department of Health 2023 report. 17.9 % of Wyoming residents are enrolled in Medicaid, 50% reside in Laramie and 3 other counties. 61.2% are children under the age of 18. 19.5 % are in Laramie County.

Goshen County is 2.7%, and Platte County is 1.7% of Medicaid enrollment. In addition, it was reported that 29% of seniors (65+) live alone, and 35% of older adults (45+) experience loneliness. According to Census Bureau, 12.5 % of Wyoming's population under 65 lacks health insurance. Poverty also impacts many residents due to the limited access to services geographically. Wyoming ranks 11th in poverty in the nation. The poverty rate in Wyoming is 11.4%. 32.2 % in Wyoming lived with less than 50,000 a year in 2024. The three counties Youth Alternatives Foster Grandparent Program serves rated out as Laramie County being 11th in the state, Platte 12th, and Goshen County 17th out of 23 total counties.

In terms of education, according to the Wyoming Department of Education, Wyoming's graduation rates increased by two-tenth (.02) for the eighth consecutive year during the 23-24 school year. It is important to note that the Foster Grandparent Program has been a part of this educational process since 1976. The 2024 Child Find report found that 14.9 % of children were not comfortable talking with adults in our counties. Nearly a quarter of parents with children ages 6 to 17 said their child had been bullied in the previous year. One in five kids has struggled to make friends, and among parents with children in that same age group, more than 35% expressed some level of concern or anxiety about the safety of their neighborhood. Nutritious meals were not affordable for a third of families. Furthering household anxiety, a quarter of parents said they had no one to turn to for emotional support with raising their kids. A third said they were doing only somewhat well or not handling the demands of parenting. This shows the need for Foster Grandparents to mentor and tutor students in the schools to help combat the challenges facing families.

Laramie County is the first in the population with 102,497 of Wyoming's 23 counties. Laramie County, with an unemployment rate of 2.3%, and an overall poverty rate of 3.3%, is host to Cheyenne, the largest city in Wyoming, with a population of close to 64,000 people and the seat of State Government and Laramie County Government. The poverty rate is 10.3 % in Laramie County. Employment has exceeded pre-pandemic levels in the leisure & hospitality, professional & business services, and retail trade. Job recovery is especially slow in natural resources, mining and wholesale trade, transportation, warehousing, & utilities. According to the Bureau of Labor Statistics, the Laramie County economy has been stable over the last few years and has experienced modest growth. The unemployment rate for Wyoming is 3.6 in 2025 compared to 3.5 in 2024, and in Laramie County, 2.9 from 4.4 in the 2025, according to the Bureau of Labor Statistics. Two school districts are in Laramie County, Laramie County School District #1 and #2 (LCSD #1-14,010 & LCSD #2-1,066), with a combined enrollment of 14,629 students, K-12.

Goshen County has a population of 11,691 and covers 2,226 square miles. Goshen County is home to Wyoming's Medium Security Correctional Facility and has an agricultural economy. Of the 11,691 residents, 20.31% are 65 years of age or older, with another 17.28% being under the age of 18. Additionally, 10.2% of the residents 65 and under are without health insurance. The poverty rate for this county is 8.1%. Goshen County School District #1 (GCSD #1) has a total enrollment of 1,636 students, K-12. The unemployment rate is 3.0 % as of 2025.

Platte County, with a population of 8,443, covers 2,085 square miles. Platte County has an agricultural economy and is home to the Laramie River Station, providing electric power to communities in eight states. Of the 8,443 residents, 24.7% are 65 or older, with another

20.5% under 18. There were no statistics of how many residents 65 and under are without health insurance. Uninsured children from 6 to 17 was 26.6% in 2025 . The poverty rate for this county is 11.1%, and the unemployment rate is 3.7%. Platte County School District #1 (PCSD #1) has 901 students, K-12 in 2025.

To meet the needs of these communities' interventions to combat the items mentioned above will be impacted through Foster Grandparents working one on one or in small groups of children daily, two to three times a week or weekly for fifteen hours or more per week to those children that are at risk of falling behind in subjects or needing to advance in subjects. It is the intention that this intervention will likely lead to the outcomes identified in our work plans and help to combat the three counties' needs.

Other demographic and social factors assist in setting the stage for identifying the needs and problems that make the Foster Grandparent Program so imperative in these communities as follows: *The graduation rate for the class of 2023-24 was 81.6%. * The number of single-parent families in the state with is 9.09% with children in the home in 2025. In 2024, there were 3,532 cases of child protection cases, as reported by Child Protective Services. That is 6.8 out of every 1,000 children (2024 Department of Family Services annual report). * Wyoming had 168 suicide deaths in 2024, an increase from 156 in 2023 according to the state of Wyoming who used caution in comparison with our low population. The 2024 rate was 23.1 increase from the 25.6 per 100,000 people in 2022, while the National average is 14.7 per 100,000 (Center for Disease Control and Prevention). Laramie County had 27 suicide deaths with 4 more nonresidents in 2024, increasing from 20 in 2023. (Coroner 2024 Annual Report).

Youth Alternatives Foster Grandparent Programs provides an environment where all feel welcomed, respected, represented, supported, and valued by age, national origin, religion, disability, sex, socioeconomic status, education, marital status language spoken, physical appearance, or geography. Youth Alternatives treats all fairly and giving access and opportunities to all people/volunteers and works to identify and eliminate barriers that may have limited full participation in groups prior. All volunteers will be included in all program activities in relation to the Youth Alternatives and the Foster Grandparent Program. To ensure the program engages in the recruitment of volunteers is to recruit in all areas of the city and county and let anyone who is interested apply, meet the federal income and age guidelines and pass all the required processes for enrollment, including background checks, into the program.

Youth Alternatives Foster Grandparent Program provides an environment to feel welcomed, respected, supported, and valued as part of the program. Volunteers will be embraced by recruiting and accepting volunteers based on their talents and abilities. Youth Alternatives

provides fair treatment and access to service by meeting all the eligibility components and providing the opportunity to grow and advance in their service to the community. Youth Alternatives Foster Grandparent program plans to recruit, interview, and enroll volunteers who will make a difference for all in the community by allowing them to serve when they meet the federal income, and age guidelines and pass all required enrollment processes including background checks.

Performance measurements will focus on Education for school readiness and K-12 success. Volunteers are improving measurements and increasing the performance measures every day. The Youth Alternatives Program is shooting to meet the 36 VSY standard Recruitment for achieving the 36 VSY's will be a priority in meeting performance measures.

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Volunteerism improves health by strengthening the body, improving mood, and lessening stress in participants, according to Volunteer Hub. Volunteers are an asset and should be treated as such. The Nonprofit Hub suggested tips including the following: say thanks; build a community; equip them; respect their time; show them impact; and listen to their feedback. With these tips in mind, volunteers will be thanked in a variety of ways for the time they have served. They must see their service time as helping the program achieve its annual target of required hours. This will be accomplished through shout-outs at monthly meetings where progress towards goals will be reported. Volunteers will receive years-of-service pins, certificates of appreciation, lifetime service awards, and additional recognition as appropriate. Volunteers will be recognized as valued individuals through cards/ notes for accomplishments, birthdays, anniversaries, and personal sentiments when needed. Time will be allotted at monthly meetings for volunteers to become acquainted. Structured and unstructured "Get to Know You" activities will encourage a sense of belonging and ownership of the program.

Making new friendships and staying socially engaged is vital to the emotional stability of older adults out of the workforce and who may have experienced a loss of friends and family or are socially isolated. Through ongoing contact, volunteers will feel supported by agency staff providing solution-focused ideas, coaching, and encouragement in difficult situations. Staff will work diligently to ensure volunteer assignments match the Foster Grandparents' skills and abilities. Through successful assignments, Foster Grandparents will know they are valued and their work is essential. Foster Grandparents will be apprised of their impact through various modalities and will see the importance of their role in the program and how it improves their communities. A volunteer evaluation of the program will be conducted annually. The evaluation will seek feedback on how the program has

impacted the volunteer's life and whether it meets their needs. The evaluation will allow the Foster Grandparent's to submit suggestions for improvement and future trainings. Two recognition events will be planned for the volunteers, including a Youth Alternatives annual Volunteer Appreciation event, and a Winter Appreciation event. Volunteers, community representatives, volunteer agencies, elected officials, and others will be invited to these events to demonstrate the volunteers' importance and service. U.S. military Veterans will also be recognized at these events and receive special community recognition in conjunction with Veteran's Day.

Notice of Priority has improved educational outcomes for economically disadvantaged children. Work Plans will show the importance of improving the educational outcomes in the following three years through the work of the Foster Grandparents. In addition, a plan to grow the culture of understanding and acceptance in volunteer stations will be done through station/site training and monitoring for further training for the school districts community bias and staff teams as needed so stations supervisors can be involved with the recruitment of volunteers to address community disparities and bias in recruitment efforts.

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Recruitment and Development: Youth Alternatives Foster Grandparent Program recruits on an everyday basis. Recruitment annually has three to four billboards placed around Cheyenne, flyers posted in multiple locations, multiple times in all counties. Presentations continue to be done in senior living complexes and every county. Public Service Announcements (PSA) are put in the local newspaper and the Trader's paper every other month, and postcards sent out to senior living spaces. Community volunteer fairs or events that bring people together are attended to for recruitment opportunities. Recruitment priority is to have volunteers from all community areas, including English Language Learners, individuals with disabilities, and veterans or military family members. The plan is to have speaking engagements to invite and educate all in the community about the Foster Grandparent opportunities and to invite the specific groups to speak at our trainings so they can educate us on how to get them more involved in the program. Advertisements will be geared toward adults over 55 that will qualify and meet the AmeriCorps Guidelines.

A comprehensive orientation is provided to qualifying applicants. Training is done on the sponsoring organization's mission and programs, program-specific rules and regulations, and working with children having special needs, building positive relationships with school professionals, and other applicable topics. Various methods will be used, including videos, guest speakers, YouTube Videos, and group discussions. Volunteers will receive a minimum of 20 hours of pre-service training. A combination of classroom instruction and

job shadowing will be utilized. Ongoing instruction and continuous volunteer development are essential to ensure volunteer success. Therefore, monthly training on topics of interest identified by Foster Grandparents and current trends and issues will be provided.

Local media, including newspapers, radio, television, and social media, will be utilized to recruit and retain individuals who qualify to be Foster Grandparent. In addition, participation in community events such as health fairs, Super Day in the Park, workforce service career fairs, and school functions will increase community awareness of the program and available opportunities.

The proposed service area of Wyoming: Laramie, Goshen, and Platte counties have a total population of 121,917. The major population centers in these counties are the cities/towns of Cheyenne, Torrington, and Wheatland, and will be the focus of recruitment activities. Cheyenne is the largest population of 102,497 plus and the largest service area. The ethnic breakdown is 82.19% white, 2.25 % Black/African American, 4.04% two or more races, 8.99 multiracial, 1.11% Asian, 0.13% native Hawaiian and other Pacific Islander and 1.29% American Indian. According to the Wyoming News .com, 13.5% of the adults in Laramie County are veterans.

The population of Torrington is 11,691, with 85.6% white, 9.7% Hispanic, with a small black percentage and 0.6 % make up the rest of other racial and ethnic groups . In 2023,Torrington has a poverty rate of 8.1% and a median age of 43.4. There are significantly more women than men over age 65 living in poverty. It is estimated that 9.6% of the population are Veterans.

Wheatland has a population of 8,443 people with an ethnic composition of 88.7% white, 5.7% Hispanic, the county has a significant number of individuals identifying as Black or African America, American Indian and Alaska Native, Native Hawaiian and other Pacific Islander and some other race. In 2023 Platte county's poverty rate was 0.558% The median age is 50. It is estimated 8% of the population are Veterans.

Strategies to reach the qualifying volunteers will be targeted toward income qualifying and senior complexes, speaking at senior housing complexes, women's leagues, and around the community events, along with posting flyers, having billboards, postcards, regular Traders and newspaper ads, and being in the housing and churches newsletters in each county to reach as many men and women possible. In addition, the plan is to enroll anyone that meets the federal guidelines and is interested in making a difference for the children in our communities to address the demographics above.

All elementary and secondary schools, Head Start, and after school programs like Boys and Girls Club are handicapped accessible. Every effort is made to accommodate those

with physical disabilities. The Cheyenne Transit System as well as Lions Disability Transport Service and the senior transit programs in Torrington and Wheatland have handicapped-accessible buses and offer curb-to-curb services to those who qualify. Also, all the agencies have handicapped parking. Accommodation will be discussed as needed with schools for volunteers to be considered to serve at them.

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Youth Alternatives Foster Grandparent Program plans and infrastructure to ensure management of volunteer stations will include Memorandums of Understanding (MOU) developed with LCSD #1, LCSD #2, GCSD #1, and PCSD #1. Additionally, MOUs will be developed with Wyoming Child and Family Development (Head Start), Boys and Girls Club. The MOUs will be negotiated between the Mayor, the Director of Youth Alternatives, the FGP Coordinator, and the appropriate volunteer agency personnel. The MOUs will outline the responsibilities and expectations of each party. The MOUs will include appropriate and inappropriate activities volunteers may and may not engage in. The MOUs will also have an outline of expected paperwork, including Volunteer Assignment Descriptions, Volunteer Evaluations, Timesheet Approvals, and the culture of the volunteer station for safe spaces for the volunteers. The MOUs will also include any in-kind donations and the value to be provided by the volunteer stations. FGP staff will work directly with volunteer station staff such as principals, teachers, and other supervisory staff to assign volunteers in safe spaces. Meetings will be arranged with teachers, principals, and supervisory staff to provide station training on supervising volunteers and reviewing the station/ site training to include the FG Handbook. FGP staff members will make formal and informal visits to volunteer stations throughout the year to ensure that volunteers perform appropriate service activities and are in a culturally safe environment. Youth Alternatives Foster Grandparent Program will collect data to show the program's impact on academic achievement, graduation rates, and social/ emotional growth supported by the volunteers. The plan for addressing the culture of volunteer stations was discussed above in Youth Alternatives mission is to intervene in the lives of young people at an impressionable stage in their emotional growth and development when positive behaviors are more easily formed. Youth Alternatives is committed to equal treatment when addressing community needs and Performance Measures by providing fair treatment and access to service by meeting all the eligibility components and providing the opportunity to grow and advance in their service to the community and in reaching the Performance Measures.

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The City of Cheyenne and the Office of Youth Alternatives will provide fiscal oversight of the Foster Grandparent Program. The day-to-day bookkeeping and accounting will be handled

by Frederika Barela, Operations Manager at Youth Alternatives. Frederika retired from the City of Cheyenne as the City Treasurer and later returned to work at Youth Alternatives. The Youth Alternatives Director and Foster Grandparent Coordinator will review expenditures and payments. The expenditures will be approved by the City Governing Body and then paid by Robin Lockman, City Treasurer. Internal Policies and operating procedures are well established to provide governance and manage risk to provide sound program and fiscal oversight.

Youth Alternatives Director, Jay Sullivan, has been with the organization for 34 years and has served as the Assistant Director and the Court Services Coordinator during his tenure. Jay will ultimately be responsible for the supervision and continued success of the Foster Grandparent Program. Regarding defined paid staff positions, Allyson Montgomery was hired on December 7, 2021, as the Program Coordinator. Allyson has a BS in Human Services and worked for the Foster Grandparent Program for over five years. Her previous experience came from the local federally funded Head Start program for 20 years, 18 of those years in administration. She has an extensive grant, federal reporting, and managing experience. Youth Alternatives, under the City of Cheyenne, lost the Foster Grandparent Assistant Program Coordinator, due to the looming funding situation. A new possible part time assistant will not be hired until funding is secured then a succession plan for future leadership of the Foster Grandparent Program will be in place. With this structure, these two positions would provide adequate staffing to operate the program to accomplish program objectives. Present Operation Support and Finance staffing exist within Youth Alternatives and the City Treasurer's office. They would be part of the process of paying bills and managing grants. The organization works within the community to have a qualified staff, client, board members and volunteers, and will continue to accept qualified candidates as employees and volunteers that comply with the federal and city/county requirements.

Youth Alternatives has an annual General Fund budget of \$539,383.00. Additional annual grant funds total \$1,244,748.00. Youth Alternatives has earned the City Administration's and the community's respect, operating within its budget and administering City, State, and Federal Funds. As a city department, the Youth Alternatives budget also has oversight from the City Treasurer. Further, Youth Alternatives follows all procedures, guidelines, policies, and procedures, and those established by the City of Cheyenne to comply with reporting any fraud, waste and/or abuse. City policies are in place for managing capital assets, supplies, segregation of duties, internal oversight of funds and Youth Alternatives will follow these policies for the Foster Grandparent Program. Training on these policies and procedures occurs at orientation training after criminal history is conducted. The sponsoring entity's financial systems and federal grant experience are well documented,

and the complete City financials are audited annually. The numerous programs operated by Youth Alternatives demonstrate their capacity to continue as sponsors, support, and programmatic and fiscal oversight of the Foster Grandparent Program.

Youth Alternatives Foster Grandparent Program will collect data to show the program's impact on academic achievement, graduation rates, and social/ emotional growth supported by the volunteers. The collection of data is done in Excel spreadsheets. The performance data is shared with the Foster Grandparents, Advisory Council, and Youth Alternatives Director monthly for timely training and instruction. In addition, the data gives real-time information so Foster Grandparents, volunteer stations, and the program can respond to current trends and needs.

Program Management: The Youth Alternatives ACCISS program is no longer running in the community, so the Foster Grandparent transitioned to the Boys and Girls Club STEAM program as well as the Mentoring and Tutoring program at Youth Alternatives. MOUs are in place for Foster Grandparents to serve at: Laramie County Community College Children's Discovery Center, Laramie County School District # #2, and more Foster Grandparents have been placed in Laramie County School District #1. The Foster Grandparent Program now serves in 21 locations.

Recruitment: Recruitment continues to be a concern in getting enough people to meet the Volunteer Service Year VSY's requirement. Twenty new Foster Grandparents have been recruited since the last grant, though we had twelve officially retire, move away, exit due to health reasons or not able to serve any longer. A reduction in VSY's was made when offered and recruitment has been strong to little avail in meeting the VSY requirement. Approximately 55 people are needed to fill the 36 VSY requirement based on working hours currently served.

The program follows this plan in recruiting and in our daily work. Maintaining an environment where all feel welcomed, respected, represented, supported, and valued by age, national origin, religion, disability, sex, socioeconomic status, education, marital status, language spoken, physical appearance, or geography. The Youth Alternatives Foster Grandparent Program sponsored by The City of Cheyenne, Office of Youth Alternatives is committed to fostering, cultivating, and preserving a culture of belonging.

Our human capital is the most valuable asset we have. The collective sum of the individual differences, life experiences, knowledge, inventiveness, innovation, self-expression, unique capabilities, and talent that our volunteers invest in their service to our community represents a significant part of not only our culture, but our reputation and sponsors achievement as well.

We embrace and encourage our volunteers' differences in race, color, national origin, age, religion, sex, disability, political affiliation, marital or parental status, military service, physical and mental ability, socio-economic status, and other characteristics that make our volunteers unique. The Office of Youth Alternatives has this displayed in the office: Every client shall have impartial access to services regardless of race, religion, sex, ethnicity, age, physical handicap, type of mental health or substance abuse disorder, or source of financial support. Each client's personal respect and privacy shall be recognized and respected.

All Foster Grandparent volunteers have a responsibility to treat others with respect at all times. Foster Grandparent volunteers are expected to exhibit conduct that reflects respect during service, at volunteer functions on or away from volunteer stations, and at all other program-sponsored trainings and events.

Any volunteers found to have exhibited any inappropriate conduct or behavior against others may be subject to disciplinary action as outlined in our Foster Grandparent Program Volunteer handbook.

Volunteers who believe they have been subjected to any kind of discrimination that conflicts with Youth Alternatives Foster Grandparent Program policy and initiatives should seek assistance from the Foster Grandparent Program Coordinator or the Director of Youth Alternatives.

Though the program is continuing to meet our goals in this area, training is always welcomed, and growth encouraged in this area.

Fraud, Waste and Abuse Plan: The City of Cheyenne Office of Youth Alternatives Foster Grandparent Program has policies and procedures in place for the reporting without delay any suspected criminal activity, waste, fraud and/or abuse to AmeriCorps Office of Inspector General and AmeriCorps. Orientation and annual training for the staff and participants is provided for the awareness plan in reporting. The Youth Alternatives Foster Grandparent Program under The Office of Youth Alternatives and The City of Cheyenne Office has strong mechanisms to prevent fraud and waste including requiring two staff signatures on spending documentation at any amount and written permission required from leadership team members for larger amounts.

The Office of Youth Alternatives being part of The City of Cheyenne, and a government agency, has the appropriate safeguards and policies in place to prevent, detect, and mitigate the risk of fraud, waste, abuse, and mismanagement through segregation of duties, following the internal oversight and timesheet policies. Program staff are given information when hired regarding when and how to contact OIG if they suspect fraud,

waste, abuse or criminal activity in the program. Accounting staff also check each item expensed to ensure its compliance and proper documentation.

Prohibited activities and criminal history checks follow the City of Cheyenne Office of Youth Alternatives monitoring and oversight through the policies and procedures that ensure the compliance and detection of any non-compliance following the rules of AmeriCorps and the Office of Youth Alternatives Foster Grandparent policies in place for the program enrollment, training, site location training and monitoring visits. Annual training is done on the AmeriCorps Litmos site to ensure compliance.

Supplemental Stipend: Through grantee share, an additional \$0.25 per hour will be provided to all AmeriCorps Senior volunteers serving on the grant.

Section:

Budget:

The City of Cheyenne Office of Youth Alternatives is basing the budget on 55 volunteers to meet the 36 Volunteer Service Hours. This is based on the hours currently being served by volunteers. State of Wyoming Aging Division, Community Living Section and United Way of Laramie County and Laramie & Goshen County School districts are the sources for the 51,272.00.

Source of Funds:

Section I. Volunteer Support Expenses:

Proposed funding: State of Wyoming \$17,843 Secured funding: United Way of Laramie County - \$2,589 TOTAL = \$20,432

Section II. Volunteer Expenses, C

Proposed funding: State of Wyoming \$10,429, Secured Funding: United Way of Laramie County \$889.26, City of Cheyenne \$4,347.83 Laramie County \$2,173.91

Unsecured Funds: MOUs with School Districts and donations \$13,000 TOTAL = \$51,272

Supplemental Stipend: Through grantee share, an additional \$0.25 per hour will be provided to all AmeriCorps Senior volunteers serving on the grant. $\$0.25 \times 1044 \times 36 \text{ VSYs} = \$9,396$

2027 Budget Narrative: City of Cheyenne Office of Youth Alternatives -Foster Grandparent

Section I. Volunteer Support Expenses

A. Project Personnel Expenses

Position/Title -Qty -Annual Salary -% Time	CNCS	Grantee Share	Total Amount	Excess Amount
Program Coordinator: - 1 person at 61,368 x 100 % usage	52163	9205	61368	0
Temporary/ Part time - 1 person at 23920 X 100% usage	20332	3588	23920	0
Category Totals	72495	12793	85288	0

B. Personnel Fringe Benefits

Item -Description	CNCS Share	Grantee Share	Total Amount	Excess Amount
Health Insurance: Health, dental, vision based on current costs. 2 employees covered for a single benefit averaging 1,662/mo. x 12mo = 19,948	9282	1638	10920	0
FICA: As required by law@7.65% x taxable wages 105,666 x.0765=8,083	5596	988	6584	0
Retirement: In accordance with personnel policies, the grantee staff are eligible for 14.62% of salary. 2 employees @ .1462 x 105,666 = 15,552	7723	1363	9086	0
Workers Compensation: As required by law @ 2.68% x qualified wages. \$105,666 x .0268 = \$2,832	2195	387	2582	0
Longevity: In accordance with personnel policies the grantee fulltime staff are eligible for longevity pay based on years of service 1 employeeX 65X12 = \$780	663	117	780	0
Life Insurance: In accordance with personnel policies, the grantee staff are eligible for life insurance 1 employees x \$4/mo x 12 = \$48	41	7	48	0
Category Totals	25500	4500	30000	0

C. Project Staff Travel

Local Travel

Purpose -Calculation	CNCS Share	Grantee Share	Total Amount	Excess Amount
Local Travel: City rate \$.72.5/mile for avg of 86 miles X 12 monthsfor 2 staff to monitor schools and Foster Grandparents. An additional \$1,500 for use of City vehicle to be used when staff travel to Goshen/Platte Counties.	3000	0	3000	0
Category Totals	3000	0	3000	0

Long Distance Travel

Purpose -Destination -Other Travel -Trans. Amount -Meals/ Lodging	CNCS Share	Grantee Share	Total Amount	Excess Amount
Long Distance Travel/Professional Development: Attendance for 2 staff at CNCS convening. - Meals/Lodging 1,800 Trans 3,500, Other \$700	5408	592	6000	0
Category Totals	5408	592	6000	0

D. Equipment

Item/Purpose -Qty -Unit Cost	CNCS Share	Grantee Share	Total Amount	Excess Amount

	0	0	0	0
Category Totals	0	0	0	0

E. Supplies

Item/ Purpose -Calculation	CNCS Share	Grantee Share	Total Amount	Excess Amount
Supplies: For 2 FGP staff, 55 vol. Ink for two printers - 4 ink cart. X \$175.00 x 3x each year = \$2,100, Cons. items: copier paper, mailing envelopes, labels \$175, PPE supplies, sanitizer, masks, gloves \$150, File folders \$35, Misc desk supplies: includes tape, pens, etc. \$40 = \$2,500.	2500	0	2500	0
Category Totals	2500	0	2500	0

F. Contractual and Consultant Services

Purpose -Calculation	CNCS Share	Grantee Share	Total Amount	Excess Amount
	0	0	0	0
Category Totals	0	0	0	0

I. Other Volunteer Support Costs

Item	CNCS Share	Grantee Share	Total Amount	Excess Amount
Criminal Background Check: \$55 each for 43 volunteers	2400	0	2400	0
Volunteer Recruitment: 350 Flyers \$100, 600 Posters \$150, 8 Billboards x \$800= \$6,400, Advertisements - \$350 = 7,000	4453	2547	7000	0
Volunteer Training: 15 trainings per year. Expenses: room rentals, av equipment = \$1,000, 165 packets @\$1.00 each= \$165, serve food/bev. for 55 vol. = \$1,185. Total: \$2,350	2350	0	2350	0
National Association Dues: AmeriCorps Senior Professional Network (ASPN) \$250 per person X 2 = \$500	500	0	500	0
Telephone: Cell phones and monthly service for 2 staff @ \$125/month = \$2,652. ZOOM subscription \$22X12 = \$264 Total - 3,264	2916	0	2916	0
Internet Service: monthly service on 8 iPads @ \$29 per month for FG use in classrooms with the students and for inservice training = \$348	348	0	348	0
Postage: Based on current cost of \$108/mo x12 = \$1,300	1300	0	1300	0
Printing: Volunteer handbooks \$225, Volunteer Assignment Descriptions \$350, program/invitations recognition events \$100, Recruitment poster/ copier expenses \$300, Yearbook \$325= \$1,300	1300	0	1300	0
Category Totals	15567	2547	18114	0
Section Total	124470	20432	144902	0

Section II. Volunteer Expenses

A. Stipends

Item - # -Annual Stipend	CNCS Share	Grantee Share	Total Amount	Excess Amount
Corporation Funded: - 1,044 x \$4.00 x 36 = 150,336	150336	0	150336	0
Non-Corporation Funded: - 0 x 1,044	0	0	0	0
Supplemental Stipend - .025 X 1044 X 36 VSYs = 9,396		9396		
Category Totals	150336	9396	159732	0

B. Other Volunteer Costs

Item -Description	CNCS Share	Grantee Share	Total Amount	Excess Amount
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Meals: Volunteers will be reimbursed training meals, a total of 24 days x \$6.00 per meal x 55 volunteers = \$7,920. 13,000 unsecured included from MOU's with volunteer stations.	6392	1528	7920	
Clothing: Branded clothing for 55 Foster Grandparents at \$27.27 for 3 items each to wear to school.	4500	0	4500	0
Insurance: Volunteer Insurance as per Acrisure/CIMA quote for accident and liability based on 55 X \$5.45 for accident and volunteer liability insurance at a minimum of \$100. These are the minimums allowed.	250	50	300	0
Recognition: Room rental - \$2,000 (\$1,000 x 2), Food \$6346 (\$38.46 x 55 meals X 3 events) Winter Appreciation, Youth Alternatives Volunteer Recognition, Senior Corps Week luncheon: Each requires room rental and food.	4666	3680	8346	0
Appreciation gifts: Senior Corps branded gifts, miscellaneous cards, certificates, and pins. \$65 year X 55 volunteers = \$3,600.	3512	88	3600	0
Volunteer Travel: Volunteers will be reimbursed for travel to and from their home to their volunteer station and to program events. 55 volunteers on average of 260 days per year X 2.89 miles at \$.72.5/mile.	26902	3098	30000	0
Physical Examinations: 36 volunteers x \$140 per physical	5040	0	5040	0
Category Totals	51262	8444	59706	0
Section Totals	201598	17840	219438	0
PERCENTAGE	78%	22%		

Budget Totals	\$326,068	\$38,272	\$364,340	
PERCENTAGE	89%	11%		

Source of Funds

Section	Description
Section I. Volunteer Support Expenses	Secured funding: State of Wyoming \$17,843, United Way of Laramie County - \$2,589 TOTAL = \$20,432
Section II. Volunteer Expenses	Secured Funding: State of Wyoming \$10,429, United Way of Laramie County \$889.26, City of Cheyenne \$4,347.83 Laramie County \$2,173.91. \$13,000 unsecured included from MOUs with volunteer stations. TOTAL = \$30,840

Performance Measures

% of Unduplicated Volunteers in Work Plans that result in Outcomes: 100%

% of Unduplicated in the Primary Focus Area: 100%

Performance Measure: Performance Measure: 1.1 Tutoring

Community Need to be Addressed:

According to the Wyoming Department of Education, WY-TOPP and WY-ALT scores for 2024-25, 29.60% of 4th grade students in Laramie County School District #1 scored Proficient in English Language Arts (ELA), 32.37% in science and 20.82% in Math. In Laramie County School District #2, 4th grade students scored proficient at 33.33 % in ELA, 31.94% in science and 19.44% in Math. In Platte County School District 4th grade student scores were 35.62% Proficient in ELA, 46.58% in science and 28.77% in Math. In Goshen County School District #1, 4th grade student proficient scores were 28.93% in ELA, 29.75% in science, and 23.14% in math. These are the four school districts to be served by Foster Grandparents in Southeast Wyoming by Youth Alternatives Foster Grandparent Program. WY-TOPP reports 4th grade reading scores have increased since 2022. The WDOE also reports that all content areas have seen an increase and ELS and Science have reached or exceeded the pre-pandemic levels with math only 0.4% behind the 2019 scores. The graduation rate for the class of 2024 in Wyoming was 1.5%, higher in Wyoming. In these districts, 38.3% qualify for free and reduced lunch. From the US Department of Education, it shows that only 35% of high school seniors are proficient in reading, with the lowest scores on record. The National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP) 2024 result shows that nationally, the average mathematics score for fourth graders went up 2 points since 2022 and 3 points higher compared to the pandemic scores in 2019. Eighth grade scores went lower by 8 points in 2024 compared to 2019. According to Education Week, Tutors/ Mentors serve as a thoughtful partner for students in their academic journey and help empower them to become autonomous learners and agents of their own change. Numerous sources concur that one-to-one attention helps students develop better study skills and increases their knowledge of core subjects. Students with learning disabilities are most likely to see the benefits of tutoring.

Focus Area: Education Objective: K-12 Successful Number of Volunteer Stations: 15

Anticipated Unduplicated: 34

Anticipated Volunteers: 45

Service Activity: Tutoring

Service Activity Description: Approximately 32 to 36 Foster Grandparents will be in assigned schools to be positive role models to assigned 2 to 10 students. They will work with assigned children while using the approved school curriculum. Foster Grandparents will work predominantly on reading, math, and behavioral skills one-to-one or in small groups as assigned by the teacher 15 to 40 hours a week. Foster Grandparents will model positive social skills, encourage good listening, provide gentle guidance, and positive behavior reinforcement for school success. Foster Grandparents will model, comfort and nurture young children, especially kindergartners, and others who need extra emotional support.

Anticipated ED1A: Number of individuals served

Target: 125 How Measured: Tracking System

Instrument Description: Volunteer Assignment Description (VAD) completed by school personnel at the beginning of the service period to designate the assigned children and their academic or other specific needs.

Anticipated ED27C: Number of students with improved academic engagement or social-emotional skills

Target: 100 How Measured: Tracking System

Instrument Description: Volunteer Assignment Description completed by school personnel at the end of the service period to track the progress of the children based upon approved school assessments and/or professional observation.

2.1 Other Classroom Support

Community Need to be Addressed:

Head Start is a federal program that promotes the school readiness of children from birth to age five from low-income families by enhancing their cognitive, social, and emotional development. Head Start programs provide a learning environment that supports children's growth in many areas such as language, literacy, and social and emotional development. According to the National Head Start Advantage report, Head Start provides parenting training opportunities, improves parent involvement and parent-child relationships, and decreases parental distress. According to the Kids County 2024 Data Wyoming, there are 27.08 % single parent homes in these 4 counties with children under the age of 18 living in poverty compared to 3.42% in 2021. Head Start is a comprehensive, classroom based Early Childhood Education option that helps prepare these most vulnerable children to succeed in school and life. Children are assigned to Foster Grandparents at the beginning of the school year (September). A volunteer assignment description is completed for each grandparent identifying the specific children and the children's special needs that have been identified by Head Start Staff. Head Start is a 4 day per week program, 6 hours per day. Grandparents serve assigned children approximately 24 hours per week. Progress is measured mid-year (January) and at the end of the year (May).

Focus Area: Education Objective: School Readiness Number of Volunteer Stations: 1

Anticipated Unduplicated: 1

Anticipated Volunteers: 1

Service Activity: Other Classroom Support

Service Activity Description: Approximately 2 Foster Grandparents will work one to one or in small groups of children of 3 to 5 to will assist them to complete academic tasks, develop social and emotional skills, provide comfort, and encourage self-efficacy skills, 15 to 40 hours per week. The Head Start curriculum rotates small numbers of children between teachers and paraprofessionals as well as the Foster Grandparent in the classroom. Foster Grandparents will serve with 2 to 15 children each during the school year.

Anticipated ED1A: Number of individuals served

Target: 10 How Measured: Tracking System

Instrument Description: Volunteer Assignment Description (VAD) completed by Head Start personnel at the beginning of the service period to designate the assigned children and their academic or other specific needs.

Anticipated ED23A: Number of children demonstrating gains in school readiness

Target: 7 How Measured: Tracking System

Instrument Description: Volunteer Assignment Description completed by Head Start personnel at the end of the service period to track the progress of the children based on teacher observation and/or other approved instrument capable of measuring changes in school readiness.

Performance Measure: 3.1 Tutoring

Community Need to be Addressed:

Boys and Girls Club is an after-school program geared towards providing social support, education services, after school and summer activities as well as family services and mentoring for Junior High Students. Youth Alternative Mentoring and Tutoring works with kids all year round after school with homework and projects. ReThink Together in January 2022 found that an interdisciplinary approach to learning helps students learn how to solve problems by recognizing bias, thinking critically, embracing ambiguity, and analyzing ethical concerns. The University of Central Florida found that by integrating the arts into STEM, STEAM-focused curricula incorporate the study of the humanities, language arts, dance, drama, music, visual arts, design, new media and more. Students who explore and master any of these subjects can make themselves more marketable in today's workforce, as 57% of senior leaders value soft skills more than hard skills, according to a 2018 LinkedIn report. A 2019 LinkedIn report notes that creativity, persuasion, and collaboration are the top three skills companies seek in prospective employees. Numerous other studies have demonstrated that participation in an afterschool program can improve classroom behavior, school attendance, academic aspirations, and can reduce the likelihood that a student will drop out. Youth will be assigned to the grandparents at the beginning of the school year (September). A volunteer assignment description is completed for each grandparent identifying the specific youth and their special needs which have been identified by Boys and Girls Club staff. Boys & Girls Club and Youth Alternatives Mentoring and Tutoring are a 5 day per week programs, 4 hours per day. Grandparents will serve 2 to 4 hours per week (September-May) in this program and are considered placed dually. Progress is measured mid-year (January) and at the end of the year (May).

Focus Area: Education Objective: K-12 Successful Number of Volunteer Stations: 1

Anticipated Unduplicated: 1

Anticipated Volunteers: 1

Service Activity: Tutoring

Service Activity: Approximately 1 Foster Grandparents will model positive social skills, encourage good listening, provide gentle guidance, and positive behavior reinforcement and serve as positive role models in a 21st Century STEAM based after-school program for 2 to 15 hours a week. Foster Grandparents will work with 2 to 10 junior high aged students utilizing the STEAM curriculum to promote learning in the areas of Science, Technology, Engineering, Art, and Mathematics. Foster Grandparents will provide homework assistance to students to improve academic success with 7th and 8th graders.

Anticipated: ED1A: Number of individuals served

Target: 3 How Measured: Tracking System

Instrument Description: Volunteer Assignment Description (VAD) completed by Boys and Girls Club personnel at the beginning of the service period to designate the assigned children and their academic or other specific needs.

Anticipated ED27C: Number of students with improved academic engagement or social-emotional skills

Target: 2 How Measured: Tracking System

Instrument Description: Volunteer Assignment Description completed by Boys and Girls Club personnel, who have access to student's grades and personal observation of youth involvement and participation.